

KYLE GAARDER

Product Manager | Community Platforms | Customer Discovery

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SUMMARY

Product builder who designs community-driven experiences from scratch. Conducted 48 customer interviews, launched a coliving product from zero, and iterated based on real user feedback. I specialize in community platform products where trust and belonging are the core value proposition. My approach combines deep user empathy with rapid experimentation.

For Kindred: I build community products where trust is the core value — 48 customer interviews, 0-1 product launch, and rapid iteration from real user feedback.

Founder, Product & Operations

Revillage Coliving

- 📅 08/2022 - 07/2024 📍 Austin, TX
- Launched an 8-bedroom coliving property in 2 weeks, reaching 100% occupancy before lease start
 - Designed the complete resident experience - onboarding, engagement loops, and retention systems
 - Built community as the product - 48 dinners, 4 masterminds, and 6 work-trade programs
 - Ran A/B pricing experiments driving 48% revenue lift while maintaining 94% occupancy
 - Maintained 94% occupancy for 19 months through continuous product iteration and user feedback
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- Directed full-cycle operations, improving efficiency 212% YoY through process optimization
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- Facilitated smooth acquisition transition to Macro House while maintaining user satisfaction

Co-Founder, Strategy & Operations

Van Village

- 📅 01/2021 - 08/2022 📍 Portland, OR
- Built demand pipeline of 3,140 subscribers through grassroots outreach and validation
 - Conducted 48 customer interviews to guide product-market fit and feature prioritization
 - Explored partnerships across 5 states and personally secured an investor-backed pilot program
 - Led product concept development across strategy, ops, and community in startup environment

Co-Founder, Operations & Growth

Lake Barcroft Boats

- 📅 01/2011 - 01/2016 📍 Falls Church, VA
- Built a niche service business from zero to 140+ clients
 - Achieved 82% customer retention through relationship-driven service
 - Generated 46% year-over-year revenue growth by improving pricing, operations, and service offerings
 - Personally closed 30-40 new clients per summer through direct outreach and referrals
 - Managed scheduling, pricing, contractors, and customer relationships across 230+ completed service contracts

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

-  **48 Customer Interviews**
Structured customer discovery program guiding product-market fit and feature decisions
-  **Community Product from Zero**
Designed and launched community-based housing product from concept to full occupancy
-  **94% Retention via Product**
Product-driven retention sustained 94% occupancy for 19 months in emerging market
-  **Investor Pilot Secured**
Sourced and secured an investor-backed pilot for a new community concept across 5 states
-  **Demand Pipeline Built**
Built early demand pipeline of 3,140 subscribers through concept validation and outreach

SKILLS

- Product Management
- Customer Discovery
- Community Product Design
- User Research & Empathy
- Rapid Experimentation A/B Testing
- Stakeholder Management Specs
- Partnerships Market Creation

EDUCATION

- Bachelors in Science, Biology**
Virginia Tech
📅 08/2010 - 05/2014
📍 Virginia, USA
• Minors in Psychology, International Studies, Spanish
- GPA
3.5 / 4.0